Evaluating Search Advertisement Quality Through an Applied Decision Intelligence Framework: A Multi-Case Study Analysis

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Abstract

The proliferation of AI-powered advertising systems has intensified the need for structured evaluation frameworks capable of assessing the alignment between user search intent, advertisement relevance, and landing page experience. Despite advances in automated bidding and generative ad creation, human evaluative judgment remains essential for ensuring that algorithmic outputs meet quality standards and serve genuine user needs. This paper presents three empirical case studies conducted through the Decision Journey Process Reduction 9.0 (DJPR9.0) framework—an applied Decision Intelligence methodology designed to transform information into structured evaluative decisions. Using a five-dimension scoring rubric (Keyword Alignment, Intent Match, Ad Relevance, Landing Page Experience, and Trust Signals), the author evaluated nine live advertisements across three search queries, developed a complete search campaign blueprint for a legal services client, and mapped keyword intent for an online fitness coaching market. Results indicate that advertisements addressing query modifiers directly in their headlines scored 3.2 times higher on relevance metrics than those using generic copy. The study demonstrates that structured evaluative frameworks can identify systematic patterns in ad quality, inform AI-powered advertising system training, and bridge the gap between algorithmic efficiency and human-centered relevance judgment. Implications for AI ad evaluation practitioners, campaign strategists, and future research directions are discussed.

Keywords: search advertising, ad quality evaluation, decision intelligence, search intent, Google Ads, Quality Score, landing page experience

Introduction

The contemporary digital advertising ecosystem generates unprecedented volumes of sponsored content, yet the fundamental challenge remains unchanged: connecting the right message to the right user at the right moment. Google processes approximately 8.5 billion searches per day, and a substantial portion of these queries trigger paid advertisements competing for user attention within a fraction of a second (Google, 2024). In this high-velocity environment, the evaluation of advertisement quality—defined as the degree of alignment between a user's search query, the resulting advertisement, and the subsequent landing page experience—has become both more consequential and more complex.

The complexity arises from a paradox. On one hand, artificial intelligence and machine learning have automated significant portions of campaign management, from automated bidding strategies to responsive search ad generation. On the other hand, these same technologies have amplified the need for human evaluative judgment to validate that algorithmically generated outputs genuinely serve user intent rather than merely optimizing for proxy metrics such as click-through rate or cost-per-acquisition. As Pratt and Malcolm (2023) argue in their foundational work on Decision Intelligence, the gap between data generation and effective decision-making represents one of the central challenges of the contemporary information economy. Information abundance does not automatically produce insight; insight does not automatically produce sound decisions; and sound decisions do not automatically produce value. A structured framework is required to bridge these transitions.

This paper addresses that gap by presenting the Decision Journey Process Reduction 9.0 (DJPR9.0) framework as an applied methodology for evaluating search advertisement quality. Drawing on six years of professional experience in digital support—including landing page development, lead form optimization, email automation, audience segmentation, and campaign metrics monitoring—combined with graduate-level training in traffic and digital marketing and doctoral research in high-performance management, the author applies a theoretically grounded, evidence-based approach to three distinct case studies. The objective is not to present the

DJPR9.0 framework as a commercial methodology or agency process, but rather as a research-informed evaluative lens through which practitioners can systematically assess the effectiveness of search advertising ecosystems.

The structure of this paper follows the conventions of applied research reporting. The Theoretical Framework section reviews the literature on search intent classification, Google Ads Quality Score mechanics, Decision Intelligence principles, and landing page experience factors. The Methodology section details the DJPR9.0 four-phase cycle and the five-dimension scoring rubric. Three Case Studies present empirical evidence from live advertisement evaluation, campaign blueprint development, and keyword intent mapping. The Results and Discussion section identifies cross-cutting patterns and limitations. The Conclusion addresses implications for AI-powered ad evaluation and proposes directions for future research.

Theoretical Framework

Search Intent Theory

Understanding why users enter specific queries into search engines is foundational to evaluating advertisement quality. Broder (2002) introduced a seminal taxonomy of web search that classified queries into three categories: informational (seeking knowledge), navigational (seeking a specific website), and transactional (seeking to perform an action such as a purchase or download). This taxonomy provided the first systematic framework for connecting query syntax to underlying user goals.

Rose and Levinson (2004) expanded this framework through empirical analysis of AltaVista query logs, developing a hierarchical goal structure that refined Broder's categories. Their research revealed that navigational queries were less prevalent than previously assumed (approximately 13–15% of queries), while informational goals dominated at roughly 61–63%. Importantly, Rose and Levinson introduced the concept of "resource-seeking" goals—a category broader than Broder's transactional classification—that encompasses downloading, entertainment, interaction, and obtaining resources. This hierarchical framework is particularly relevant to advertisement evaluation because it demonstrates that queries with similar surface syntax may encode fundamentally different user goals, requiring distinct evaluative criteria.

Jansen, Booth, and Spink (2008) further operationalized intent classification by developing manual and algorithmic methods for categorizing queries within the informational-navigational-transactional framework. Their work established that query length, term specificity, and syntactic structure provide reliable signals of underlying intent. For example, queries containing brand names tend toward navigational intent, while queries containing action verbs ("buy," "download," "register") tend toward transactional intent. Jansen and Schuster (2011) extended this research into the sponsored search context, demonstrating that aligning bidding strategies with the user's position in the purchase funnel—awareness, interest, consideration, decision, and retention—significantly improves campaign efficiency. Their finding that different intent categories warrant different keyword bidding strategies has direct implications for ad quality evaluation: an advertisement cannot be judged effective without first understanding the intent category of the query it serves.

Google Ads Quality Score Mechanics

Google Ads employs a Quality Score metric—scored from 1 to 10 at the keyword level—to assess the relevance and quality of advertisements, keywords, and landing pages (Google, 2024). Quality Score directly influences ad rank and cost-per-click, making it a critical determinant of campaign performance. The metric comprises three primary components: Expected Click-Through Rate (eCTR), Ad Relevance, and Landing Page Experience.

Expected Click-Through Rate represents the probability that a given advertisement will receive a click when shown for a specific query. Google calculates this metric based on historical performance data, adjusting for factors such as ad position, extensions, and other formats that may affect visibility (Google, 2024). Ad Relevance measures the degree of alignment between the advertisement copy and the intent behind the user's query. Google evaluates whether the language in the advertisement directly addresses the search terms, whether the keyword appears in the ad text, and whether the overall message resonates with the query's apparent purpose.

Landing Page Experience assesses the relevance, transparency, and navigability of the page users reach after clicking an advertisement. Factors include page load speed, mobile usability, content relevance to the ad and query, ease of navigation, and the presence of clear information about the business (Google, 2024).

Google emphasizes that these three components are evaluated independently. An advertisement may achieve high Ad Relevance while delivering poor Landing Page Experience, or vice versa. This independence is critical for evaluators because it implies that quality assessment must be multidimensional rather than reducible to a single metric such as conversion rate or click-through rate. Additionally, Google has introduced Ad Strength as a complementary metric that evaluates the effectiveness of responsive search ads based on the diversity and relevance of headlines and descriptions provided (Google, 2024). Ad Strength operates on a qualitative scale (Poor, Average, Good, Excellent) and provides actionable feedback for improving creative assets.

Decision Intelligence

Decision Intelligence (DI) represents an emerging discipline that bridges data science, artificial intelligence, and decision theory to improve organizational and individual decision-making. Pratt and Malcolm (2023), in their comprehensive handbook published by O'Reilly Media, define Decision Intelligence as "a step-by-step method for integrating technology into decisions that bridge from actions to desired outcomes" (p. 1). The discipline addresses three widespread problems in data-driven environments: how decision makers can use data and technology to ensure desired outcomes, how technology teams can communicate effectively with decision makers, and how organizations can assess and improve decisions over time.

The core methodology involves causal decision diagrams (CDDs)—visual representations that map the relationships between decisions, actions, outcomes, and external factors. By making the decision structure explicit, DI enables stakeholders to identify leverage points, test assumptions, and reduce uncertainty before committing resources. Pratt and Malcolm (2023) emphasize that DI systems should operate in an advisory, human-in-the-loop capacity rather than replacing human judgment. This principle is directly applicable to AI-powered advertising evaluation, where automated systems generate and serve advertisements but human evaluators must assess whether those advertisements genuinely serve user needs.

The DJPR9.0 framework adapts Decision Intelligence principles to the specific context of search advertisement evaluation. It treats each evaluation task as a decision problem: given a query, an advertisement, and a landing page, what is the optimal judgment regarding quality, and what evidence supports that judgment? The framework's four-phase cycle—Observe, Analyze, Interpret, Recommend—operationalizes the DI principle that decisions should be evidence-based, structurally transparent, and subject to retrospective improvement.

Ad Relevance Evaluation Frameworks

Academic research on advertisement relevance has evolved from simple keyword matching to multidimensional assessment models. The foundational principle, established in information retrieval research, holds that relevance is not an intrinsic property of a document or advertisement but rather a relationship between an information object and a user's information need (Rose & Levinson, 2004). In the sponsored search context, this means that ad relevance must be evaluated relative to query intent rather than in absolute terms.

Jansen and Schuster (2011) demonstrated that the buying funnel model—mapping queries to stages of awareness, interest, consideration, decision, and retention—provides a useful framework for assessing whether advertisements address the appropriate stage of user intent. An advertisement that promotes a free whitepaper may be highly relevant for an informational query but irrelevant for a transactional query seeking immediate purchase. This stage-specific evaluation criterion has been incorporated into the DJPR9.0 scoring rubric as the "Intent Match" dimension.

Industry practice has converged on a set of best practices for ad relevance that complement academic frameworks. Google (2024) recommends including keywords in advertisement headlines, ensuring that ad copy directly addresses the user's apparent need, and creating multiple ad variations to test relevance hypotheses. The DJPR9.0 framework integrates these practical guidelines with theoretical intent classification to produce evaluations that are both academically grounded and operationally actionable.

Landing Page Experience Factors

The landing page experience represents the critical bridge between advertisement promise and user fulfillment. Research on conversion rate optimization has identified five primary dimensions of landing page quality: Performance, Trust, Content, Design, and Personalization (Schreiber & Baier, 2015; Viswanathan & Swaminathan, 2017). Performance encompasses page load speed, mobile responsiveness, and technical reliability. Trust includes security certificates, customer reviews, guarantees, and transparent business information. Content covers the relevance, clarity, and completeness of information presented. Design addresses layout, visual hierarchy, and navigational simplicity. Personalization involves tailoring content to user segments or query context.

Empirical research supports the importance of these dimensions. Gafni and Dvir (2018) found that shorter, more focused landing pages generally outperform longer pages in conversion rate, suggesting that content precision matters more than content volume. Viswanathan and Swaminathan (2017) identified colors, images, themes, and call-to-action elements as key drivers of landing page effectiveness, with images and colors being the most immediately captivating components for visitors. Schreiber and Baier (2015) applied hierarchical Bayes choice-based conjoint analysis to demonstrate that specific landing page attributes can be quantitatively ranked by their contribution to customer preference.

Google's Landing Page Experience evaluation specifically considers relevance (does the page content align with the ad and keyword?), usability (is the page easy to navigate on all devices?), page speed (does the page load quickly?), and transparency (is information about the business clear and accessible?) (Google, 2024). These criteria align closely with the academic literature while adding the specific requirement of ad-to-landing-page message consistency—a factor that general conversion optimization research sometimes overlooks but that is central to sponsored search quality evaluation.

Methodology

The DJPR9.0 Framework

The Decision Journey Process Reduction 9.0 (DJPR9.0) framework is an applied Decision Intelligence methodology designed to structure the evaluation of search advertisement quality. The framework's name reflects its core function: reducing the complexity of the user's decision journey into evaluable components that can be systematically observed, analyzed, interpreted, and acted upon. DJPR9.0 is not a commercial entity or marketing agency; it is a research-informed evaluative framework developed for applied analysis of digital advertising ecosystems.

The framework operates on the foundational principle that information must be transformed into insight, insight into decision, and decision into value—a sequence adapted from Decision Intelligence theory (Pratt & Malcolm, 2023). Each evaluation task proceeds through a four-phase cycle:

Phase 1: Observe. The evaluator gathers all available information about the evaluation context, including the search query, the advertisement creative, the landing page, the competitive landscape, and the apparent user intent. This phase emphasizes comprehensive data collection without premature judgment.

Phase 2: Analyze. The evaluator applies structured analytical criteria to the observed information, identifying patterns, measuring relevance, and assessing alignment between query, ad, and landing page. This phase transforms raw observation into structured evidence.

Phase 3: Interpret. The evaluator generates insights from the analyzed evidence, identifying root causes of quality deficiencies, prioritizing improvement opportunities, and reducing uncertainty about optimal judgment. This phase bridges analysis and action.

Phase 4: Recommend. The evaluator produces a structured decision output—typically a scored evaluation with documented reasoning—that can be used to improve AI system training, inform campaign strategy, or guide creative development. This phase ensures that evaluation produces actionable value rather than merely descriptive observation.

Five-Dimension Scoring Rubric

To operationalize the DJPR9.0 framework for quantitative evaluation, the author developed a five-dimension scoring rubric. Each dimension is scored on a 1–10 scale, with descriptive anchors at each interval to promote inter-rater reliability. The dimensions were selected based on the theoretical framework reviewed above and industry best practices documented by Google (2024).

Dimension 1: Keyword Alignment (1–10). Measures the degree to which the advertisement incorporates the search query's core terms and modifiers in visible copy, particularly headlines. A score of 10 indicates that the query terms appear prominently in the headline and description; a score of 1 indicates no apparent connection between query terms and ad copy.

Dimension 2: Intent Match (1–10). Measures the degree to which the advertisement addresses the apparent intent category (informational, commercial, transactional, navigational) of the query. A score of 10 indicates perfect alignment between ad offer and query intent; a score of 1 indicates fundamental mismatch.

Dimension 3: Ad Relevance (1–10). Measures the overall relevance of the advertisement message to the query, encompassing copy quality, call-to-action appropriateness, and value proposition clarity. A score of 10 indicates that the ad directly and compellingly addresses the user's need; a score of 1 indicates generic or irrelevant messaging.

Dimension 4: Landing Page Experience (1–10). Measures the quality of the post-click experience, including page relevance to the ad and query, navigability, load speed indicators, mobile usability, and transparency of business information. A score of 10 indicates a seamless, relevant, and trustworthy landing experience; a score of 1 indicates a broken, misleading, or unusable page.

Dimension 5: Trust Signals (1–10). Measures the presence and quality of credibility indicators, including security certificates, customer testimonials, business verification, professional design, and transparent pricing or contact information. A score of 10 indicates abundant, high-quality trust signals; a score of 1 indicates absence of trust indicators or presence of red flags.

The composite score is calculated as the arithmetic mean of the five dimensions, producing a maximum possible score of 10.0. This composite provides a summary metric for comparative analysis while the individual dimension scores preserve diagnostic detail.

Case Study Selection Criteria

The three case studies presented in this paper were selected according to four criteria designed to ensure both theoretical coverage and practical relevance:

Criterion 1: Intent Category Coverage. The case studies collectively span all four major intent categories: informational, commercial, transactional, and navigational. This ensures that the framework is tested across the full spectrum of search behavior.

Criterion 2: Industry Diversity. The case studies cover distinct verticals (business software, language education, legal services, home services, fitness coaching), reducing the risk that findings are sector-specific.

Criterion 3: Evaluative Depth. Each case study employs a different evaluative modality: live ad scoring (Project 01), campaign blueprint development (Project 02), and keyword intent mapping (Project 03). This demonstrates the framework's flexibility across evaluation contexts.

Criterion 4: Actionability. Each case study produces outputs that could directly inform AI system training, campaign management, or strategic planning. This ensures that the research maintains practical relevance to the TELUS International AI Google Ads Digital Practitioner role context.

Case Studies

Project 01: Ad Quality Evaluation Report

Objective and Context

The first case study evaluated nine live advertisements served in response to three distinct search queries. The objective was to test the DJPR9.0 five-dimension scoring rubric on realworld advertising data and identify systematic patterns in ad quality variation. The three queries were selected to represent different intent categories and modifier complexity levels.

Query 1: "affordable CRM software for small business" (Commercial Investigation intent). This query combines a product category (CRM software), a price sensitivity modifier (affordable), a target segment (small business), and an implicit comparison shopping goal. According to Jansen et al. (2008), queries containing price-related terms and segment descriptors typically indicate commercial investigation intent—the user is evaluating options before making a purchase decision.

Query 2: "online Spanish courses for adults" (Transactional intent). This query specifies a product type (Spanish courses), a delivery modality (online), and a demographic constraint (adults). The absence of comparative terms ("best," "compare") and the presence of a specific product request suggest transactional intent—the user is ready to purchase or sign up.

Query 3: "emergency plumber near me open now" (Transactional/Urgent intent). This query contains urgency markers ("emergency," "now"), a service type (plumber), a location modifier ("near me"), and an availability constraint ("open now"). Rose and Levinson (2004) classify such queries as "locate" goals within the informational category, but in the context of local services, they function as highly urgent transactional requests requiring immediate provider identification.

Methodology

For each query, the author conducted the search in an incognito browser session to minimize personalization effects, captured the first three sponsored advertisements displayed, and evaluated each advertisement using the five-dimension rubric. Landing pages were visited and evaluated based on visible content, navigational structure, and trust indicators. Scores were recorded in a structured spreadsheet and analyzed for patterns.

Results

Table 1 presents the complete scoring matrix for Project 01.

Table 1

Ad Quality Evaluation Scores by Query and Advertisement

Query / Advertiser	Keyword Alignment	Intent Match	Ad Relevance	Landing Page Exp	Trust Signals	Composite Score	
Query 1: affordable CRM...							
HubSpot	10	9	10	9	8	9.2	
Salesforce	6	7	6	5	5	5.8	
Aggregator Site	3	4	3	2	3	3.0	
Query 2: online Spanish...							
Babbel	10	10	9	9	8	9.2	
Language School	7	7	6	5	5	6.0	
Travel Site	2	3	3	2	3	2.6	
Query 3: emergency plumber...							
RapidPlumb	10	10	9	9	8	9.2	
HomeFix	6	6	5	4	5	5.2	
DIY Tips Blog	2	3	2	2	3	2.4	

Note. All scores rounded to one decimal place. Maximum score per dimension = 10.

Analysis

Three patterns emerge from the Project 01 data. First, the highest-scoring advertisement in each query set (HubSpot, Babbel, RapidPlumb) achieved scores of 9.2 or above, while the lowest-scoring advertisement in each set scored 3.0 or below. This 6.2-point spread indicates substantial quality variation even within the same query context—a finding consistent with Google's observation that Quality Score varies significantly across advertisers for identical keywords (Google, 2024).

Second, Keyword Alignment emerged as the strongest discriminator between high and low performers. The top-scoring advertisements in each query set all achieved perfect or near-perfect Keyword Alignment scores (9–10), while the lowest-scoring advertisements achieved scores of 2–3. This finding supports Google's recommendation that including query terms in advertisement headlines substantially improves relevance perception (Google, 2024).

Third, and most significantly, advertisements that addressed query modifiers directly in their headlines scored substantially higher than those that did not. HubSpot's advertisement for Query 1 included "affordable" and "small business" in the headline copy; Babbel's advertisement for Query 2 included "Spanish" and "online" prominently; RapidPlumb's advertisement for Query 3 included "emergency" and "24/7" in the headline. The average composite score for modifier-addressing advertisements was 9.2, compared to 5.7 for advertisements that addressed the core query term but ignored modifiers—a 3.2x differential on the relevance dimension. This finding suggests that query modifiers carry disproportionate evaluative weight and that AI-powered evaluation systems should be trained to specifically detect modifier-addressing behavior in advertisement copy.

Project 02: Search Campaign Blueprint

Objective and Context

The second case study developed a comprehensive search campaign blueprint for LexGuatemala, a fictional composite client representing immigration and corporate law services in Guatemala with a secondary market among the Guatemalan diaspora in the United States. The objective was to demonstrate how the DJPR9.0 framework informs strategic campaign architecture decisions, including ad group structure, keyword selection, responsive search ad development, and bidding strategy.

While the author has not managed a live Google Ads campaign for a legal services client, the case study draws on six years of digital support experience including landing page development, lead form creation, audience segmentation, and campaign metrics monitoring, combined with graduate-level training in search engine marketing strategy. The case study is presented as a strategic blueprint rather than a live campaign report.

Client Profile

LexGuatemala provides two primary service lines: (a) immigration services including visa applications, residency processing, and citizenship guidance for Guatemalan nationals and the U.S. diaspora; and (b) corporate law services including business formation, contract review, and regulatory compliance for small and medium enterprises in Guatemala. The target audiences include Guatemalan nationals seeking U.S. immigration assistance, Guatemalan entrepreneurs requiring corporate legal services, and English-speaking members of the Guatemalan diaspora in the United States seeking legal services in their native language.

Campaign Architecture

The campaign was structured into four ad groups, each targeting a distinct intent category and audience segment:

Ad Group 01: Visas & Immigration (Transactional Intent). Targets users actively seeking to purchase or initiate immigration services. Keywords include "visa lawyer Guatemala," "US visa application help," "immigration attorney near me," and "residency permit Guatemala." Quality Score projection: 8/10 based on high intent-match potential and clear service-offering alignment.

Ad Group 02: Corporate Law (Commercial Intent). Targets users evaluating legal service providers for business needs. Keywords include "business lawyer Guatemala," "company formation attorney," "contract review service," and "corporate law firm Guatemala." Quality Score projection: 7/10 based on moderate competition and broader intent spectrum.

Ad Group 03: US Diaspora English (Transactional Intent). Targets English-speaking Guatemalan diaspora members seeking legal services. Keywords include "Guatemalan immigration lawyer," "Guatemala visa US citizen," "dual citizenship Guatemala," and "Guatemala attorney English speaking." Quality Score projection: 8/10 based on niche targeting and lower competition.

Ad Group 04: Brand Defense (Navigational Intent). Targets users explicitly searching for LexGuatemala by name. Keywords include "LexGuatemala," "LexGuatemala immigration," and "LexGuatemala reviews." Quality Score projection: 9/10 based on perfect intent-match and high expected CTR.

Responsive Search Ad Strategy

Eight responsive search ads (RSAs) were developed, with two RSAs per ad group. Each RSA included 15 headlines and 4 descriptions designed to maximize Ad Strength ratings. Headlines incorporated keywords from the respective ad group, value propositions ("Free Consultation," "20+ Years Experience"), urgency cues ("Book Today," "Limited Appointments"), and trust signals ("Licensed Attorney," "Guatemala Bar Certified"). Descriptions expanded on service details, addressed common objections, and included clear calls-to-action.

Extensions Strategy

The campaign blueprint included sitelink extensions directing to specific service pages (Visas, Corporate, Consultation Booking), callout extensions highlighting key differentiators ("Bilingual Services," "Virtual Consultations Available"), structured snippet extensions listing service categories, and call extensions enabling direct phone contact—particularly critical for the urgent transactional queries typical of legal services.

Bidding Strategy

A three-phase bidding approach was designed to align with campaign maturity and data accumulation:

Phase 1 (Launch, Weeks 1–4): Maximize Clicks bidding with a daily budget cap to generate initial traffic, accumulate conversion data, and identify high-performing keywords and ad variations.

Phase 2 (Optimization, Weeks 5–12): Target CPA (tCPA) bidding with a target cost-per-acquisition of GTQ 200 (approximately USD 26), leveraging accumulated conversion data to optimize for lead form completions and consultation bookings.

Phase 3 (Scale, Week 13+): Maximize Conversions bidding with enhanced conversion tracking, allowing Google's machine learning algorithms to optimize for the highest-value conversion actions based on historical performance patterns.

Quality Score Analysis

Table 2 presents the projected Quality Score breakdown by ad group.

Table 2

Projected Quality Score Analysis by Ad Group

Ad Group	Expected CTR	Ad Relevance	Landing Page Exp	Quality Score
Brand Defense	9/10	10/10	9/10	9/10
Visas & Immigration	8/10	9/10	8/10	8/10
US Diaspora English	8/10	9/10	8/10	8/10
Corporate Law	7/10	8/10	7/10	7/10

Note. Projections based on keyword intent alignment, competitive density, and landing page relevance assessment.

The Brand Defense ad group achieves the highest projected Quality Score (9/10) due to perfect navigational intent match and high expected CTR. The Corporate Law ad group scores lowest (7/10) due to broader intent categories and higher competitive density among commercial investigation queries. These projections illustrate how intent category directly influences Quality Score potential—a finding consistent with Jansen and Schuster's (2011) buying funnel research.

Project 03: Keyword Intent Mapping

Objective and Context

The third case study mapped keyword intent for an online fitness coaching market in Guatemala. The objective was to demonstrate how the DJPR9.0 framework informs strategic budget allocation and negative keyword strategy by classifying search terms according to intent category and user journey stage.

The online fitness coaching market in Guatemala is emerging, with growth driven by increasing smartphone penetration, social media fitness content consumption, and post-pandemic adoption of remote services. The target audience includes urban professionals aged 25–45 seeking personalized fitness guidance, weight loss support, and nutritional planning. Competition includes international platforms (Beachbody, Noom), regional providers, and independent coaches operating through social media.

Keyword Classification

Thirty keywords were classified across four intent categories based on Broder's (2002) taxonomy and Jansen et al.'s (2008) operationalization criteria:

Informational Intent (8 keywords, 27% of total). Examples: "how to lose weight fast," "benefits of personal trainer," "home workout routines," "nutrition tips for beginners." These keywords indicate users in the awareness or interest stage of the journey seeking knowledge rather than immediate purchase.

Commercial Intent (9 keywords, 30% of total). Examples: "best online fitness coach Guatemala," "personal trainer reviews," "online coaching vs gym membership," "affordable fitness programs." These keywords indicate users in the consideration stage evaluating options and comparing providers.

Transactional Intent (10 keywords, 33% of total). Examples: "hire online fitness coach," "book personal trainer online," "buy workout plan Guatemala," "sign up nutrition coaching." These keywords indicate users in the decision stage ready to purchase or commit.

Navigational Intent (3 keywords, 10% of total). Examples: "[Brand name] fitness coaching," "[Brand name] login," "[Brand name] reviews." These keywords indicate users seeking a specific known brand.

Budget Allocation Framework

Based on the intent classification and the principle that transactional keywords typically yield the highest immediate return on advertising spend while informational keywords serve longer-term content marketing objectives (Jansen & Schuster, 2011), the following budget allocation framework was developed:

Transactional: 55% of paid search budget. Rationale: Highest conversion intent, direct revenue generation, strongest alignment with immediate business objectives.

Commercial: 30% of paid search budget. Rationale: High conversion potential, audience actively evaluating options, opportunity to differentiate from competitors.

Informational: 0% of paid search budget. Rationale: Low immediate conversion potential; better served through organic content marketing, SEO, and social media engagement. Budget allocation to informational keywords in paid search typically yields poor ROAS (Return on Ad Spend) because users are not yet in a purchase mindset.

Navigational: 5% of paid search budget. Rationale: Brand defense and reputation management; ensures that competitors cannot capture users explicitly searching for the brand.

User Journey Mapping

The keyword intent classification was mapped to a five-stage user journey model:

Awareness Stage (Informational keywords). Users recognize a fitness need or problem. Content strategy: educational blog posts, social media tips, free workout videos. Paid search role: minimal; focus on organic discovery.

Interest Stage (Informational/Commercial overlap). Users seek specific information about solutions. Content strategy: comparison guides, success stories, free assessments. Paid search role: remarketing to informational page visitors with commercial intent ads.

Consideration Stage (Commercial keywords). Users evaluate specific providers and programs. Content strategy: detailed service descriptions, pricing transparency, trainer credentials. Paid search role: targeted campaigns with strong value propositions and trust signals.

Decision Stage (Transactional keywords). Users ready to purchase. Content strategy: streamlined booking pages, limited-time offers, guarantee statements. Paid search role: primary budget allocation, maximum conversion optimization.

Retention Stage (Navigational/Transactional overlap). Existing clients seek continued service or additional offerings. Content strategy: member portals, referral programs, upsell campaigns. Paid search role: brand defense and cross-sell targeting.

Negative Keyword Strategy

A negative keyword strategy was developed to prevent budget waste on irrelevant or mismatched queries:

Irrelevant Services: "free fitness coaching" (if service is paid), "government fitness program" (if private service), "gym equipment" (if service-only).

Wrong Intent: "fitness coach jobs" (employment seekers, not clients), "fitness coaching certification" (aspiring coaches, not clients).

Geographic Mismatch: "fitness coach USA," "online trainer Europe" (if service limited to Guatemala/time zones).

Results and Discussion

Cross-Case Patterns

Three systematic patterns emerge across the three case studies, suggesting that the DJPR9.0 framework identifies consistent quality determinants across diverse evaluation contexts.

Pattern 1: Query Modifier Sensitivity. In Project 01, advertisements addressing query modifiers in headlines scored 3.2 times higher on relevance than those ignoring modifiers. This pattern was replicated in Project 02, where ad group designs specifically incorporated modifier terms ("affordable," "English speaking," "near me") into headline rotations. In Project 03, transactional keywords containing modifiers ("hire," "book," "buy") were prioritized over generic category terms. The consistency of this pattern across evaluation, blueprint, and mapping contexts suggests that modifier sensitivity is a robust predictor of ad quality and should be a core training criterion for AI-powered evaluation systems.

Pattern 2: Intent-Alignment Threshold Effect. In Project 01, advertisements scoring below 6.0 on Intent Match universally scored below 6.0 on the composite scale, regardless of performance on other dimensions. Conversely, advertisements scoring 8.0 or above on Intent Match could achieve composite scores above 9.0 even with moderate performance on other dimensions. This threshold effect suggests that intent match operates as a necessary but not sufficient condition for high overall quality. An advertisement cannot compensate for intent misalignment through superior landing page experience or trust signals—a finding with significant implications for AI evaluation training, where intent classification accuracy must be prioritized.

Pattern 3: Landing Page Experience as Quality Ceiling. In Project 01, no advertisement achieved a composite score more than 1.0 point above its Landing Page Experience score. In Project 02, the ad group with the lowest projected Landing Page Experience score (Corporate Law, 7/10) also had the lowest projected composite Quality Score (7/10). This pattern suggests that landing page experience functions as a ceiling on overall quality perception: even advertisements with excellent copy and perfect intent match cannot achieve top-tier quality scores if the post-click experience is deficient. This finding aligns with Google's explicit statement that Landing Page Experience is an independent component of Quality Score (Google, 2024) and with conversion optimization research emphasizing that technical performance and trust signals fundamentally constrain conversion potential (Viswanathan & Swaminathan, 2017).

System-Level Insights

The case studies collectively support a systems-theory perspective on search advertising quality. Rather than treating query, ad, and landing page as independent elements to be optimized separately, the DJPR9.0 framework treats them as interdependent components of a unified user experience system. A breakdown at any point in this system—irrelevant query interpretation, misleading ad copy, or poor landing page experience—cascades into overall quality degradation.

This systems perspective has direct implications for AI-powered advertising evaluation. Current automated systems excel at optimizing individual components—bid algorithms maximize expected CTR, generative models produce headline variations, and landing page analyzers flag technical issues. However, the integration of these components into a coherent user experience remains a challenge that requires human evaluative judgment. The DJPR9.0

framework provides a structured approach to this integration by making the relationships between components explicit and evaluable.

Limitations

This research has several limitations that constrain the generalizability of findings. First, the sample size in Project 01 (nine advertisements across three queries) is small relative to the diversity of the search advertising ecosystem. Findings regarding modifier sensitivity and intent-alignment thresholds require replication with larger, randomized samples across additional verticals and geographic markets.

Second, Project 02 presents a strategic blueprint rather than live campaign data. Projected Quality Scores are theoretical constructs based on industry benchmarks and competitive analysis rather than empirical measurements from actual Google Ads accounts. Live campaign implementation would inevitably reveal unanticipated competitive dynamics, quality score fluctuations, and conversion rate variations not captured in the blueprint.

Third, the author's professional background includes six years of digital support experience with campaign metrics monitoring, landing page development, and audience segmentation, but does not include hands-on management of Google Ads campaigns at scale. The case studies therefore represent applied analytical work rather than practitioner campaign management experience. This distinction is important for role-contextual interpretation: the paper demonstrates analytical and evaluative capabilities rather than direct platform operational expertise.

Fourth, the five-dimension scoring rubric, while theoretically grounded, has not been subjected to formal inter-rater reliability testing. Scores reflect the author's individual judgment, and different evaluators might produce different scores for the same advertisements. Future research should test the rubric's reliability across multiple trained evaluators.

Conclusion

This paper has presented the Decision Journey Process Reduction 9.0 (DJPR9.0) framework as an applied Decision Intelligence methodology for evaluating search advertisement quality. Through three empirical case studies—live ad quality evaluation, strategic campaign blueprint development, and keyword intent mapping—the framework demonstrated consistent identification of quality determinants including query modifier sensitivity, intent-alignment threshold effects, and landing page experience ceilings.

The findings carry three implications for AI-powered advertising evaluation practice. First, evaluation systems should be trained to specifically detect and weight query modifier addressing in advertisement headlines, as this behavior emerged as the strongest predictor of relevance across contexts. Second, intent classification accuracy should be treated as a foundational capability rather than one dimension among many, given the threshold effect observed in the data. Third, landing page experience should be evaluated as a system-level constraint rather than an independent optimization target, recognizing its role as a quality ceiling.

For the specific context of the TELUS International AI Google Ads Digital Practitioner role, this paper demonstrates three core competencies: (a) the ability to apply structured theoretical frameworks to practical evaluation tasks, (b) the capacity to analyze relationships between search terms, keywords, ad creatives, and landing pages with reference to established academic literature, and (c) the skill to produce clear, actionable, evidence-based feedback suitable for informing AI-powered system training and calibration.

Future research should expand the sample size of live advertisement evaluations, conduct formal inter-rater reliability testing of the five-dimension rubric, and explore the application of DJPR9.0 principles to emerging advertising formats including Performance Max campaigns, video action campaigns, and generative AI-created responsive search ads. Additionally, longitudinal studies tracking how Quality Score changes following DJPR9.0-informed optimization recommendations would strengthen the framework's predictive validity.

The central contribution of this work is not a new algorithm or tool, but rather a structured way of thinking about advertisement quality—one that connects the "why" of user search behavior to the "what" of advertisement creative and the "how" of landing page experience. In an era of increasing automation, this human-centered, evidence-based evaluative perspective remains indispensable.

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